



Component 1 Section B: Media Industries and Audiences

For this section you will be using the issue of the *Daily Mirror* and pages from its online edition that you have studied in class. This issue will be **different** from the set pages studied for Section A. The print issue of the newspaper and the online pages may be for the same or different days.

AS Section A: Investigating Media Industries and Audiences / AL Section A: Understanding Media Industries and Audiences

Starting points: Media industries

The following points should be considered in relation to the complete issue of the *Daily Mirror* and the online pages you have studied in class.

The relationship of recent technological change and media production, distribution and circulation

Industry context

The *Daily Mirror* was first published in 1903 as a newspaper for women, 'to act as a mirror on feminine life'. However, the newspaper was quickly redesigned to appeal to a broader audience. The paper is now owned by Reach plc, the largest commercial, national and regional publisher in the UK. The group publishes more than 120 national and local media brands from the *Daily Mirror*, the *Daily Record* and the *Daily Express*, to local newspapers such as the *Manchester Evening News* and *The Liverpool Echo*. Reach plc states 'We connect with people where they live, on and offline, through their locations, passions and values'. (Reach plc, n.d.)

The *Daily Mirror* was once the most popular tabloid in the UK; however, as is the case with other daily newspapers, the sales have been falling year on year. The average circulation of the newspaper in December 2025 was 166,472 for paid single copies per issue (Audit Bureau of Circulations, n.d.). This figure is down 19.1 % year on year. 7,509 active views per issue on average were recorded for the digital copy of the newspaper.



Think!

Consider the fact that the newspaper with one of the highest circulation figures is the *Metro* free paper at 952,332. What does this indicate about the newspaper industry and readers?

Recent technological change, in particular the popularity of online media, has largely been responsible for the downturn in print sales; the *Daily Mirror* responded to this by launching 'Mirror Online', establishing a presence on social media sites. This move enables the newspaper to produce real-time national and global news and to update this content regularly.

The website produces accessible image-led content to appeal to a range of audiences including 'News, Politics, Football, Celebs, TV'. There are also 'Opinion' pieces by journalists and freelance commentators reinforcing the left-wing agenda of the newspaper, for example, 'Shabana Mahmood is carrying Labour's hopes, being bold is her only option' (David Burke,